

How did he feel about a 48% chance of success? He looked at me and cocked an eyebrow. “Yuck,” he said.

For grins, he computed the height of the big M (3.40) and divided it by the breakout price (20.60) to get a value of 16.5%. According to [Table 6.5](#), the pattern was tall, making him feel better. He considered B to be the launch price, and [Table 6.10](#) said there was a 52% chance of reaching it (the last line in the table).

The two values were different: a 48% chance of reaching H and a 52% chance of reaching B, which was further away. *Hmm*. Maybe a subspace anomaly would be involved. I didn't say anything to Justin because a ball wasn't involved.

He had an order to short the stock if it dropped a penny below the low at D, or 20.59. He placed an order to cover the short at 17.03 (his target), above the top of the region at H, and above round number support at 17. Once the short triggered to open the trade, he placed a stop to exit the trade should price rise a penny above C, or 24.01.

Then he sat back and watched disaster unfold. The stock broke out downward at F, placing him in the trade, and it hit the energy barrier at the price of I. As I left his house, I started whistling the *Voyager* theme song.

The stop covered his position at G for a loss of 3.42 a share, not including commissions.

What did Justin do wrong? I think he should have anticipated a pullback at the energy barrier (the knot at the price of I). After that, though, I would have expected the stock to resume the downward move to H. [Table 6.4](#) says that 60% of the time, price *does* resume the downward move. Fortunately he had a stop in place to protect his backside while he waited for the *Voyager* crew to rescue him.